Vikas PD Gawai

Contact Information

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Education

University of Wisconsin–Madison

Ph.D. in Applied Economics 2018–2024

Dissertation: Technology in the Aging World: The Role of Broadband and Green Revolution

Committee: Jeremy Foltz, Lauren Schmitz, John Mullahy, Jason Fletcher, and Priya Mukherjee

M.S. in Economics 2016–2018

University of Mumbai

Bachelor of Technology in Civil Engineering 2004–2008

Publications

Gawai, V. (2026). *Does high-speed internet (broadband) technology affect the mental health of older adults?* **Conditionally accepted**.

Sotnikov, S., Kilburn, K., **Gawai, V.**, Habarta, N., Frazier, C., and Mumford, K. (2026). *CDC's Preventive Health and Health Services Block Grant flexible funding mechanism is associated with improved population health outcomes.* **Forthcoming**, Journal of Public Health Management and Practice.

Gawai, V. and Deller, S. (2025). *Is there a link between access to broadband and health outcomes?* American Journal of Economics and Sociology.

Foltz, J. and **Gawai, V.** (2025). *Discrimination in science: Salaries of foreign- and U.S.-born land-grant university scientists.* American Journal of Agricultural Economics.

Noghanibehambari, H., Fletcher, J., Schmitz, L., Duque, V., and **Gawai, V.** (2024). *Early-life economic conditions and old-age male mortality: Evidence from historical county-level bank deposit data.* Journal of Population Economics.

Research Under External or Internal Review

Gawai, V., Habarta, N., Gould, R., Sotnikov, S., Chapman, K., Sulal, C., Checo Martinez, K., Dean, H., and Belay, E. (2026). *Cost efficiency of a centralized funding mechanism: Evidence from CDC's National Partnership umbrella cooperative agreement.*

Gawai, V., Irizarry, J., Harbour, M., Rodriguez-Rojas, C., Dean, H., and Belay, E. (2026). *Cost efficiency analysis of CDC's centralized funding mechanism using a stochastic frontier approach: Evidence from CDC's U.S.-Affiliated Pacific Islands Cooperative Agreement.*

Gawai, V., Schmitz, L., Duque, V., and Lee, J. *Effect of early-life exposure to the Green Revolution on aging outcomes in India.*

Arora, K., Basu, S., **Gawai, V.**, Gai, J., and Schmitz, L. *Cognitive function and life-course patterns: Evidence from the Longitudinal Aging Study of India.*

Working Papers

Gawai, V., Sotnikov, S., Habarta, N., Doshi, S., Wright, S., Butler Smart, K., and Ekwueme, D. U. *Association between CDC's Preventive Health and Health Services Block Grant public health infrastructure investments and the performance of state public health departments.*

Gill, A., **Gawai, V.**, McMillan, H., Bryant, D., Habarta, N., and Dean, H. *Association between CDC's accreditation funding and the performance of state health departments.*

Ekwueme, D. U., **Gawai, V.**, Dasari, S., Bermudez, Y., Rim, S. H., Sabatino, S., de Moor, J. S., Siegel, D. A., Halpern, M. T., and Yabroff, K. R. *The evolving economic burden of cancer survivors in the United States, 2011–2024.*

Gawai, V. *Spillover effects of a bicycle policy on girls' enrollment in middle schools.* **Best Research Paper, Honorable Mention.**

Gawai, V. *Effects of teacher hiring policy on students' learning in rural India: A multi-cutoff regression discontinuity design approach.*

Gawai, V. *Does broadband technology affect Social Security applications?*

Media & Impact

Internet and Mental Health, GROW Magazine Cover Story
Broadband and Social Security Applications, The Financial Findings Podcast

Technical Skills

Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, GitHub, AI Agents, MS Office

Grants, Fellowships & Awards

Diversity Fellow, School of Public Affairs, American University 2023–2024
Research Fellow, Retirement and Disability Research Center (RDRC) 2022–2024
Center for Demography of Health and Aging Research ($2,000) 2023
RDRC - Junior Scholar Research Competition Award ($5,000) 2022

Research Travel Award UW-Madison ($1,100) 2022
Deborah and David Penn Fund ($1,500) 2022–2023
UW-Madison Graduate School Award ($4,000) 2022–2023
UW-Madison Center for Demography and Ecology ($950) 2022
DEI Diversity Scholarship, American Society of Health Economics (ASHEcon) 2021
UW-Madison Traisman Agribusiness Graduate Fellowship ($750) 2021
UW-Madison Student Research Grants Competition ($1,500) 2020
UW-Madison IRIS Graduate Student Summer Fieldwork Award ($3,000) 2019
Best Research Scholarship (Honorable Mention), UW-Madison Dept. of Economics 2018
Indian State Government Scholarship for MS Economics ($100,000) 2016–2018

Teaching & Research Experience

Research Assistantships

Prof. Lauren Schmitz (UW-Madison, School of Public Affairs) 2020–2024
Prof. Jeremy Foltz (UW-Madison, Agriculture and Applied Economics) 2018–2020
Prof. Andra Ghent (UW-Madison, Wisconsin School of Business) 2018

Teaching

Econometrics Methods at CDC (CDC) 2026
Guest Lecturer, World Hunger and Malnutrition (UW-Madison) 2024
Guest Lecturer, Gender Gap and Economic Development (UW-Madison) 2022–2023
Guest Lecturer, Agricultural & Economic Development of Africa (UW-Madison) 2022
Guest Lecturer, The Economics of Race and Gender (Bentley University) 2022

Professional Service & Leadership

Editorial & Review

Associate Editor: *Preventing Chronic Disease* 2026–Present
Reviewer: *International Journal of Public Health* (2026), *Journal of Population Economics* (2025, 2026), Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (2023, 2025), Agriculture and Applied Economics Association (2022–2024), *Economics of Education Review* (2022–2023), American Society for Health Economists (2022)

Institutional Service

CDC Prevention Effectiveness Fellowship Hiring Committee 2025–2026
AAEA-Health Economics Section Official Twitter Manager 2022–2023
UW-Madison AAE Faculty Hiring Committee 2022
UW-Madison AAE Ph.D. Admission Committee 2021
Taylor-Hibbard Club, Athletic Chair 2020–2022

UW-Madison AAE Development Lab Group 2019

Mentorship

UW-Madison CDHA Research Mentor for 18 students 2022
Undergraduate Research Supervisor (2 students) 2022
Mentor, First-generation undergraduate students 2022
Mentor, First-generation underrepresented graduate students from India 2018–Present

Conferences

AcademyHealth 2026
ASHEcon 2024
Social Security Administration (SSA) Annual Meeting 2024
Data-Intensive Research Conference, University of Minnesota 2024
Midwest Economics Association 2023
Southern Economics Association 2023
Agricultural and Applied Economics Association 2022
Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management 2022–2024
Population Association of America 2022
American Education Finance and Policy Conference 2020

References

Jeremy Foltz
Agriculture and Applied Economics
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La Follette School of Public Affairs
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